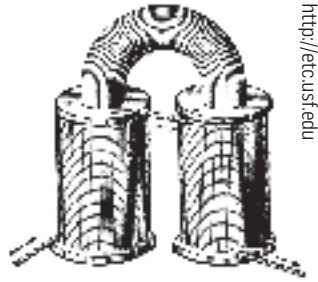


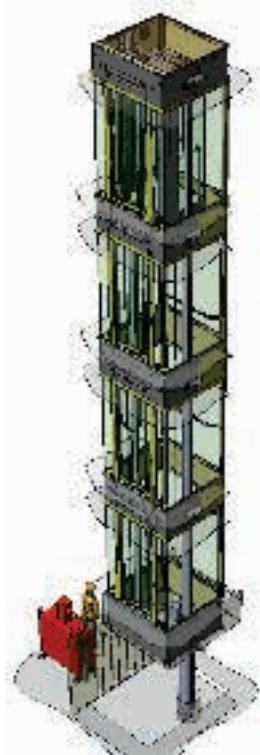
would have lost the cornerstone of rock, the air guitar. That, and the fact that it fueled some pretty obscure genres such as rock n roll, jazz and the blues.

Electromagnet

Your doorbell, car and electric guitar all have one thing in common, an electromagnet. Invented by William Sturgeon in 1825, it simply consists of a copper (or any other conductor) wire wound around an iron core and connected to a battery (source of electricity). When current passes through the wire, it magnetizes the iron core temporarily while it is running. Turns of copper wires carrying current without a core will also work as a magnet, but when wound around a ferromagnetic material such as soft iron creates a stronger electromagnet. Sturgeon displayed its power by lifting about four kilos of metal with a 200g iron core electromagnet. The wrecking yards use electromagnets to lift and move heavy pieces of scrap metal, even entire cars. A couple of years later after its invention, American scientist Joseph Henry used it for long distance communication by sending current from a mile away and causing the electromagnet to strike a bell. Thus the electric telegraph was born. The advantage of electromagnets over permanent magnets is that their magnetic field can be controlled by varying the amount of current. Therefore they're used to make controllable machines such as motors and generators. They're also used in loudspeakers to amplify the sound.



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Elevator

The invention of elevators is probably the major cause of obesity in the world. Commonly known as lifts, they've been used for "lifting" people,